

263 Go pond dipping

1
HR

A pond is a whole world of life in itself, and you can discover it by going pond dipping. Just be sure to handle all the animals you find carefully, and put them back afterward.



What you need

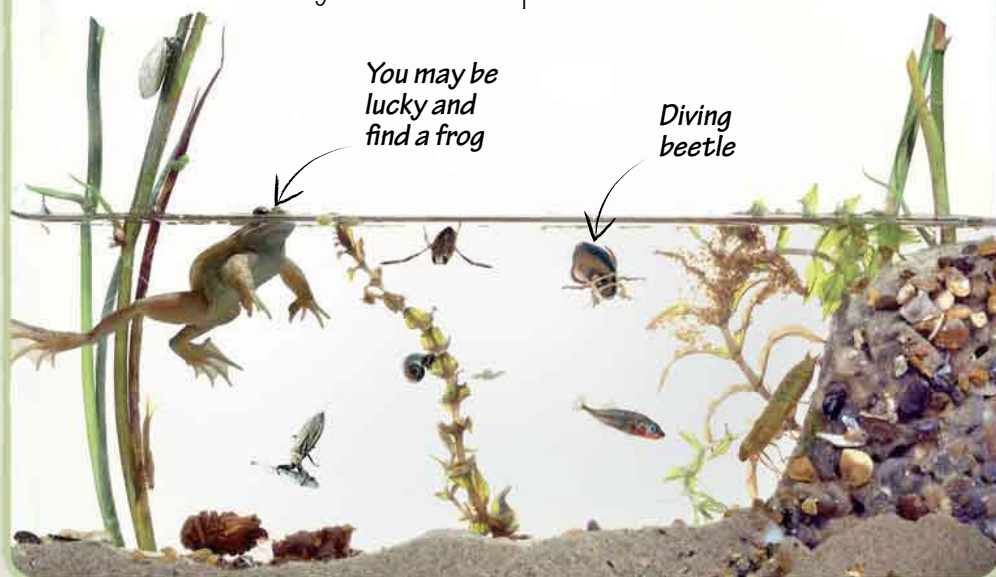
- Dipping net
- Magnifying glass
- Pond • Shallow plastic containers

1 Once you arrive at the pond, half-fill your containers with pond water. Then you're ready to put in any finds.

2 Stand at the edge of the pond with your feet firmly balanced on the bank. Kneeling may make dipping easier.

3 Put in your net and move it in a figure-8 motion. Pull it up and turn it inside-out into a container to release your catch.

4 Take a close look at your catch with the magnifying glass. Try dipping at deeper and shallower places for different creatures.



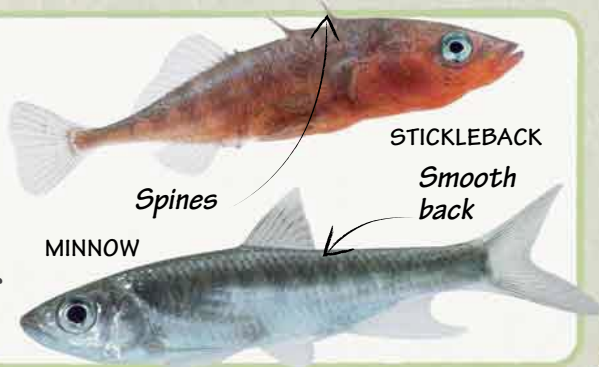
You may be lucky and find a frog

Diving beetle

264 Tell minnows and sticklebacks apart

2
MINS

Many small fish are called minnows. You can tell a stickleback apart from them by looking for the spines that give it its name. They lie in a line along its backbone.



STICKLEBACK

Smooth back

Spines

MINNOW